# Semitone

Ivan Philips

ACT 1.

SCENE 1.

INT. DINING ROOM - AFTERNOON
Few shots of an empty house, Cut to a wide shot of LUV Eating a very bland looking sandwich. He doesn't pick up the phone lying beside him throughout the meal, he's just eating. Once he is done, he gets up and goes towards the kitchen.

SCENE 2.

INT. KITCHEN - AFTERNOON
We see a big pile of dishes, next to his tiny plate. He picks up his phone and presses play, music plays from a speaker offscreen. Music plays into the scene. Match Cut

SCENE 3.

INT. RESTO - BAR - MID AFTERNOON
(Music is continued from previous scene)
Match Cut, TANISHA scrolling through her phone, someone approaches her table, she looks, they pass her table she looks back down at her phone.

SCENE 4.

INT. KITCHEN - MID AFTERNOON
LUV is halfway through washing dishes, glimpses of the clock to show the time, glimpses of his room. Cut to the next scene.

SCENE 5.

INT. RESTO - BAR - MID AFTERNOON
TANISHA'S date arrives, we don't see his face, TANISHA gets up to greet them, they sit back down and the waiter comes to take their order. Cut to next scene

SCENE 6.

INT. KITCHEN - MID AFTERNOON

LUV is done with the dishes and he walks out of the kitchen with his phone.

SCENE 7.

INT. BEDROOM - MID AFTERNOON

LUV turns off the music and starts playing a melody on his guitar with his notebook beside him on his bed, we catch glimpses of the room, it's dirty with clothes and random things all around. After sometime he looks at the clock and puts everything down as he looks through the clothes lying on the floor if anything is wearable. He packs his guitar and writes something on a sticky note which he sticks on the wall when leaves. We zoom in on it as we hear a door close.

SCENE 8.

INT. RESTO - BAR - LATE AFTERNOON

The conversation between TANISHA and her date seems uninteresting as the date seems to dominate the conversation. She is already done with her meal while the date is only halfway through. She asks the waiter about dessert as she motions about going to the washroom but exits the restaurant.

SCENE 9.

EXT. RESTO - BAR - LATE AFTERNOON

Opposite side of the road we see LUV waiting for the vehicles to cross the road.

SCENE 10.

EXT. RESTO - BAR - LATE AFTERNOON

We see TANISHA receive a cigarette from the shopkeeper and her trying to light it. LUV and TANISHA almost have a meet cute, they have a moment where they pass by but don’t see each other. TANISHA looks towards the door of the restaurant which closes just then.

ACT 2.

SCENE 1.

INT. RESTO - BAR - LATE AFTERNOON
We see LUV set up his instrument. People don't pay attention. He goes closer to the mic.

LUV

Good afternoon ladies and gentlemen, I hope your day is going well. .

People do not look up from their conversations

LUV

Mera naam LUV hai, aur mein aap ke liye guitar bajaunga.

Cut to TANISHA re-entering the establishment and going to her seat. They share a glance where she smiles at him, he moves on. She seems least interested in her date or LUV, she glances at her watch as she waits for her dessert. Her date doesn't stop rambling. Cut back to LUV

LUV

(playing a couple of notes to warm up)

One person looks his way, and then goes back to his conversation.

He starts playing a song. Various shots of the audience slowly reacting to his song, TANISHA turns around, she seems to have heard the lyrics somewhere. At the end of the performance he gets an applause from a few tables, there is a smile on his face.

TANISHA has finished her dessert and her date has already left but she still lingers on with a drink at her table.

SCENE 2.

EXT. RESTO - BAR - EVENING

LUV can be seen talking to a man, and is handed over a closed envelope. He checks the contents and looks back at the man.

LUV

Sharma Ji, itna hi?

UNCLE

Itna hi? Aate toh aadhe samay hi ho, fir aake bhi late kar dete ho, maine sirf pachees percent hi toh kaata hai.

LUV

Itnei mei mahine ka kharcha nahi ho payega mera Sharma ji.
Thoda aur de denge is baar toh. .
(he folds his hands)
Agle mahine se pakka hardin aauga time pei, ek bhi chutti nahi loonga please.

Sharma Ji looks unconvinced, but sighs and takes out his wallet and takes out a few more notes to give LUV.

UNCLE

Yeh lo.
(puts notes in his hands and puts wallet back in)
Vaise toh ghar chalana toh nahi padta, Aur voh, doosra wala kaisa hai? Khaate peete toh theekse ho naa dono?

LUV

Bhagwaan aapka balla karre
(touching Sharma Ji’s feet but being stopped by him) Ji haa, MEENA ji ke ghar vapis jaane ke baad toh, abhi roti sabzi mein khud se hi bana leta hu, ek din aajao, acche se khila deta hu.

UNCLE

Theek hai, theek hai, dekhte hai, RUBINA ka khaana khaa ke thak gaya hu, par … unhe yeh mat batta dena (puts his index finger on his lips), dhyaan se jaana LUV.

They hug. Sharma Ji walks into the RESTO-BAR. LUV takes the money in his hand, puts it into the envelope and keeps the envelope in his guitar bag and then puts it on. He proceeds to walk away towards the road, while he searches for his earphones. TANISHA happens to walk out of the RESTO-BAR. She notices him and calls out.

TANISHA

LUV! LUV Shah!

With his earphones halfway out of his pocket, LUV turns back in the direction of the voice. He squints but doesn't recognise her at all.

TANISHA

(cont'd)

Aap bohot badiya guitar bajate ho , kya aap professionally karte ho, ya fir aapki yeh sirf ek hobby hai?

TANISHA holds out her hand, he shakes it hesitantly

LUV

T..Thank you. Professionally toh nahi abtak par, bas apna pet bharne ke liye… vaise aap kaun?

TANISHA

Mujhe aapke lyrics kafi achi lagi, Especially the part about [include specific dialogue in relation to the song]

LUV looks confused.

LUV

Ek minute,...

(a beat)

TANISHA! Bro no way! TANISHA Sinha ! What the fuck! kitne saalo baad!

TANISHA holds her hands out and they hug for an  uncomfortable amount of time. They let go.

LUV

What are you doing here? Uncle aunty kaise hai? How is Princess?

TANISHA

Sab theek hai. Princess itni badi ho gayi hai abhi,
(gestures height of the dog)

LUV

Wait, tu Mumbai vapis aa gayi hai?

TANISHA

Company ke kaam se aayi hu.
(a beat)
Aur bolo, kya chal raha hai tumhare zindagi mein?

LUV

Kuch nahi bas, beet thi jaa rahi hai.

There is silence. It's a bit awkward. LUV scratches his head. TANISHA sways.

LUV starts to say something then stops before he even lets anything out. TANISHA prompts him.

LUV

Mei..uh..agar agar tu free hai, toh... Chod kuch nahi

TANISHA looks at him with a confused look

TANISHA

Agar mei free hu toh?

LUV

Nahi chod de. Tu kaafi busy hogi. Catching up with the old gang.

TANISHA

Aise cheezein tu assume kyu kar raha hai.

LUV doesn't answer the question, he scratches his head.

LUV

Nahi mujhe laga kyuki, itnei saal baad aayi hi ho toh, apne girl gang se toh milegi naa.

TANISHA

To be honest, humara group chodke mera sabse baat karna hi bund ho gaya tha. Infact tumm logo ne bhi contact chod diya… I felt hurt.(makes a sad face)

LUV

Yaar! I am so sorry bhai, it's just that life got so busy and…

TANISHA
(Laughing)
Bas bas, I am just kidding yaar, hota hai, I understand!

LUV

Chod! Anyways! If you are free right now, par only if you are free.. kaka ke yaha chai pene challe ? Mujhe bhi bohot time hogaya hai vaha jaake.

TANISHA seems to think about the proposal.

TANISHA

Kyu nahi? Chalo chalte hai.

LUV seems happy, he smiles. TANISHA walks and is at the edge of the road waiting for him to join her. As he joins her we hear him start up a conversation faintly.

LUV

Toh kidhar reh rahi hai tu abhi?

SCENE 3.

EXT. ROAD - EVENING -

Continuing from the last scene, we join them as they have crossed the road and are walking on the footpath. They are in the middle of the conversation.

TANISHA

Abhi toh crashing at a friend's place, par dekh rahi hu khudke liye jagah.

(a beat)

LUV

Did you ever end up getting into fashion?

TANISHA

Fashion toh nahi ho paya. Give up kardiya saalon pehele, dikaton ke vajah se.

LUV

Kya? but tera toh poora "ten step" plan tha!
(He makes air quotes)

TANISHA

Tha toh, par Life. . Kabhi kabhi plans, plans he reh jaati hai. For the better of course. Move on karte hai hum, yeh sochke ki kuch zyaada accha ho jaaye.

LUV

Toh fir abhi kya karti ho?

TANISHA
Social work. I’m working with an NGO right now.

LUV
Par idhar? Indore ki galliyan chhod ke, idhar kyu aana?

TANISHA
Udhar se nikalna tha mujhe. Itne saal udhar rehke bhi, woh shehar apna jaise nahi laga.

(a beat)

Bacche kaafi harami hote hai.

LUV looks confused.

TANISHA

(cont'd)

I know ke mein poore sheher keliye keh nahi sakti par, ek mindset hi ban gayi hai mere liye.

LUV
Tere paas udhar kya, dost nahi the?

TANISHA

School mein koi dost nahi banne, maine koshish kiya banane ka par, how do I say this, bohot hi wierd log hai. Nahi kar sakti thi unke saat relate.

LUV
Ek toh dost mil sakta tha, you know … statistically speaking.

TANISHA

Exactly! That's what I thought! Par voh bhi toh nahi hua.

LUV

Itnei saalo mei, tune fir ek bhi baar call kyu nahi kiya? Tera ek message tak nahi aaya?

TANISHA

Tujhe nahi lagta ki maine koshish ki thi?! Matlab abhi khat likh lu tere liye? Kitna maine koshish kiya sabko dhoonde. Tujhe,Sakshi, Diven, the whole gully gang, Neha,

(a beat)

Cut to LUV who makes a solemn look on his face that goes unnoticed.

TANISHA

(cont'd)

Yaha thak us chutiye Aman ko bhi. Abhi jaake jab aayi toh pata chal raha hai ki aadhe se zyaada log toh sheher kya, desh hi chodke nikal gaye.

SCENE 4.

EXT. BUS STOP - EVENING -

They reach the bus stop. They sit and wait for the bus.

LUV

Tere purane flat pei abhi, Tanya ki koi relative rehti hai. Mummy bolti hai ki unke ghar se poore din yaa toh saas bahu ka drama ya fir bhajan ki awaaz goonjti rehti hai.

LUV
(CONT'D)

(He points towards his ear)

Thodi sunne mei mushkil hoti hai. Unko ek baat teen baar bolna padta hai, phir bhi samajhti nahi. Ya fir unko samajhna hi nahi hai.

TANISHA gives a worried expression.

TANISHA
Voh firbhi seh lu, Sam ke saat reheke dimaag kharab hogaya hai mera.

LUV looks at her waiting to explain.

TANISHA
Samira, mei jiske saat reh rahi hu. Work colleague hai.
(a beat)
Vaise toh hai acchi par poora din bas apne boyfriend ke saat kit kit karti hai, fir raatko unka babu shona firse shuru ho jaata hai. Unka poora din sunke lagta hai ki, joh cheez ghar chodke aayi hu vohi idhar phirse mil gaya, voh bhi das gunna zyaada ...

LUV gives an approving nod.

TANISHA
Lekin LUV...

LUV
Kya?

TANISHA
Tu abhi bhi gaane bajaata hai. Mujhe laga ki tu kuch (hand gestures) zyaada nerdy karega.

LUV
Hein?! Vaise vibes deta tha kya mein?

TANISHA
Matlab, tere har subject mei top karne ka fir kya faayeda? Voh sab baaju mei rakhke, bhai you were the smartest in our batch! Of course barring NEHA, but still.

LUV seems to think about this a bit. There is a somewhat sour look on his face.

LUV
I know ki ideal career path toh nahi hai yeh, but padte padte laga ki, maine zindagi ke mazze hi lena bhul gaya, and uska

alternative kya, nine to five? Nahi kar paata mei bhai.(Folds hands) Maar deta khudko abtak. I don't know how A..

He stops himself.

LUV
Khair… vaise to school khatam hone ke baad toh maine bhi zyaada log se baat nahi kiya, except Tanya, yaad nahi par, shaayad saatmei thei college mei. Par tabhi bhi unse zyaada milta nahi tha.

Several buses have passed by before the one they need to take has arrived. They get in.

SCENE 5.

INT. BUS - EVENING - inside bus

The seats in the frame are empty, they occupy it.

TANISHA
Tu bol raha hai ki Diven bhi nahi?

LUV
Nope we just ended up falling out of touch. Sab log khud ke life goals ki oar baddne lag gaye, and weirdly enough itne alag sapnei hai ki, there really was no overlap.

TANISHA
Weekends par toh mil hi sakte the na?

LUV
That’s true but honestly nobody used to be free on the same weekends and at some point everyone just fucking left. Can’t blame them.

There's a moment of silence. The two just stare out of the window for sometime soaking in the evening light before the sunset. Suddenly TANISHA starts again.

TANISHA
Tere gharwaalo nei kuch bola nahi jab tunne kaha ki tu gaane bajaata hai.

LUV stops and really starts to think about his answer. More than trying to say the right thing he was focused on remembering it correctly.

LUV
Gharpe hua tha jagda for a long time. Mere baap ne of course bola, ki ek baar engineering kar lo, fir uskei baad dekh lena,
(a beat)
Par nahi. Mei apnei passion ke liye adda tha, ki nahi, this is what I want to do, but after a few months of cold war they gave in after they came for one of my open mics.
(a beat)
But what really brought about the inspiration to pursue my passion was Tarun. Tarun yaad hai tujhe?

TANISHA
Kaunsa, scholar ya nashedi vala?

LUV
(with eyes lit up)
Surprisingly enough, nashedi vala. Met him at a house party around the time we all just got into college, turns out mutual friends thei humare, bohot hi pehele se. As usual he was getting (gestures) and then I ended up staying over late that night after the party. I joined him and started talking to him. Pata chala ki he is attending an Art school for fine arts. (a beat)
And the way that he talked about it, bro he looked happy for the first time in years. He seemed, no he WAS! doing what he loved.

TANISHA
Sachmei? That so unbelieveable yaar.

LUV
Yeah! I know! , remember voh kaise school mei uthra hua chehera leke aata tha, bakchodi karke. You wouldn't have expected him to turn out like this.
(a beat)
There was an exhibition being held, for unke paintings, and he invited me! Ekdum ek high society wali feeling aayi.
(a beat)

As I saw the paintings I felt ki, agar yeh aise kuch kar sakta hai toh, why not me? Not in a competitive way, but more like ki, mei kyu efforts nahi daal raha into my strengths in an artform that I love. I tried music school, but six months in...

LUV goes silent. He wipes his face, unconciously.

LUV
(cont'd)
... I left the course. I used to sit at home for days without doing anything, just sleeping, eating and sleeping thoda aur.
(a beat)
If it wasn't for Sharma Ji, toh mei pata nahi kya karta. He found me a place to stay with A.. a friend, and let me play at his restaurant. Pehele toh sirf covers bajata tha, but then unhone bola, “Feel nahi aa rahi hai, LUV! Tu khudka gaana bajja!”
(MORE)

LUV (CONT'D)
Initially gaand phatti, ek toh itna vulnerable feel karaya but the response that I got, when I finally performed was so overwhelming ki … Wait, tuune kya poocha?

TANISHA just smiles and shakes her head.

Shots of locations as they pass by.

LUV
How are Indore ke guys?

TANISHA
Huh?

LUV
As in dating, is the culture any different from here, ki you know, hooking up vagera vagera.

TANISHA
Nah it's the same. I don't think location change karke farak padta hai. I've been on almost twelve dates in the past week an..

LUV
TWELVE!

Rest of the bus looks at them. TANISHA looks down at her feet.

LUV
(To the crowd)
So..sorry.
(To TANISHA)
I'm not judging, just number thoda above average hai, I mean it’s been what a few weeks since you’ve … I mean you are a pretty person, BHAI SORRY!

TANISHA looks back up.

LUV
(more apologetic)
Sorry.

TANISHA
As I was saying, baara dates mei se most of them toh are not looking for a serious relationship. Honestly in this day and age, who has the time to?

The bus stops, and they get off, the bus leaves.

SCENE 6.
EXT. BUS STOP - EVENING - Babulnath bus stop - same road which goes inside.

They walk away from the bus stop and continue where they left off from.

LUV
I disagree. I think people who want to make it work can work.

TANISHA
Mei nahi bol rahi ki it can't work, I am just saying that the amount of people into that conservative kind of outlook would be less, so much less, making ultimately, tera dating pool that much smaller.

LUV
I mean …

TANISHA
I don't think a person's quality drops just because they are more ...

LUV
Superficial?

TANISHA glares at him.

TANISHA
..."out there" excuse me, what?

LUV looks embarrassed.

LUV
I didn't mean it like that. I just mean... treating dates like a revolving door. Let's just move on, Tanisha, let's move on.

TANISHA continues as if un bothered.

TANISHA
I think it's fine to look for more options before theekse settling down. Itni baddi duniya hai humare paas, Itne saare log hai, itnei kum aadmiyo mei kaise mei samjhu ki yehi best choices hai mere liye.

LUV
I get that but, I don't think going on multiple dates to find a potential soulmate is really that good of a method.

TANISHA stops. They are standing in front of a Chai Tapri.

TANISHA
Kyu tujhe decision paralysis hota hai? It's good to have options LUV. What if you end up with the wrong person and you are stuck with the same person for the rest of your life even after years of knowing this is not the one for you?

LUV just stares. He walks over to the chai wala and we see TANISHA walking towards a place to sit, as he takes the chai in the background of the frame, and walks in the direction she does.

SCENE 7.
EXT. CHAI WALA - EVENING -

LUV hands over TANISHA's cup to her as he lays his guitar on the side and gets close to her. She takes some time before she takes a sip.

LUV
I don't want to be rude, par lagta hai there are things that have happened that made you say that.

TANISHA takes a sip before she starts.

TANISHA
I used to think Aman and I were different, you know.

LUV
Bacche the tumlog! Also, it's been so many years TANISHA. It's okay.

TANISHA
That's not the point LUV! I saw it after I left, itne saare red flags! Itne saare!

LUV
People change TANISHA! chod de. Who you are now isn't the same as who you were then, vohi mann mei rakh ke tu usko dede naa benefit of the doubt.

They sip their tea silently.

TANISHA
Do you think we could still work out?

LUV
As in if you hadn't moved away? No, not at all.

TANISHA
Why not?

They finish their tea and throw the cups into the bin, LUV picks up his guitar and they proceed to walk away. We follow LUV and TANISHA as they walk along a road which leads uphill.

LUV
I think he and 'you', but especially he, needed that. Aise nahi hai ki usko dard nahi hua uske baad.
(a beat)
I'll admit and agree, he might not have been the best person or boyfriend, but voh, genuinely care toh karta tha although I get that he never knew how to express it really well.
There is a moment of silence.

TANISHA
Aur abhi?

LUV
Maybe. Who knows. Bhagwaan nahi hu mei. Compared to before, I guess a much better chance. (a beat)
Tujhe kyu laga ki he was the one?

TANISHA doesn't answer immediately.

TANISHA
I don't know. Honestly in hindsight  chutiya lagta hai sochne mei ki I had feelings for him. I still do, but I don't think ki we are compatible with each other anymore.

LUV
Aise mat soch, you never know if you don't give it another try probably.

LUV stops and looks at the road in front of him, trying to search for their next destination, he glances at his watch.

LUV
Are you tired or can you still walk?

TANISHA
Try me.

LUV
Udhar chalte hai fir.

TANISHA instantaneously knows what he is talking about and gestures to him to show the way.

TANISHA

What ever happened to NEHA?

LUV
Well, we ended up dating fo...

TANISHA hits his arm, LUV winces.

TANISHA
SHUT THE FUCK UP.

SCENE 8.
Ext. Road - LATE EVENING - Malabar hill Upwards

TANISHA
(cont'd)
HOW? Tell me everything!

LUV
Kabhi se, from the start?

TANISHA
If you want to..

LUV smiles as he reminisces.

LUV
Aakri hafta tha summer vacation ka, before we started school. Building mei neeche khel raha tha.

TANISHA
Not so far back LUV! You know that’s not what I am asking you right?! Jaldi bol!

LUV
Ok ok! Calm down. Tumhare Indore jaane ke thode time baad I asked her out.

LUV just looks at her waiting for something and she stares back.

TANISHA
And that’s it? I mean we knew ki kuch toh hai but when did you realise?

LUV
Uhmm… we have to go thoda peeche in time for that.

TANISHA
(hesitantly but still interested)
Theeke theeke, bol.

LUV
Yes, toh kaha tha… ah, summer vacation. Anyways … ek din baaju ke building mei ek nayi bacchi aayi thi.
(a beat)
Ek choti si aavaz mei voh poochi ki voh khel sakti hai mere saat ya nahi. I couldn’t say no, and that’s when I first knew...

TANISHA
First knew what? Ki you like her?

LUV
Nah… that my life was about to change.

TANISHA
(leaning in)
Wait, ya’ll weren’t neighbours from the start?! But that is crazy, since I know ki tum log practically saath mei rehete thei.

LUV

That’s true, jab Neha ki family shift hui, we were practically living at each other’s houses.

TANISHA
It was so awkward when class mein people came to know ki tum dono ek dusre ko jaante ho.

Luv

Yeah, makes sense I mean, she was a prodigy—academics, sports, everything aur main? barely top ten mein aa raha tha and that was just academics, lets not even mention sports. Intimidated feel hota tha.

TANISHA

*(smiles)*

Tu aur intimidated?

LUV

Poora.

There's a pause. A rustle in the wind.

TANISHA

Why did you stop talking to her after that though I always wanted to ask.

LUV

Aah… so basically, around fifth, she started hanging out with the girls aur fir mein awkward ho gaya. Teen saal school mein ek shabd nahi bola humne because of this. I started playing music because if this.

TANISHA
What really? How?

Luv
Maine kamre mein baith kar Mummy ke purane keyboard par music bajane laga.

*(a beat)*

Aur phir tum dono aaye saath mein. Annual day prep, jab Aman ne mujhe tumse milwaya.

TANISHA

Ah yes! I remember. Do you remember how awkward Aman was? Cute toh tha voh.. Back then.

LUV

Exactly, just the awkward part, not the cute one. But get this. Meine form toh solo ka bhara tha, par unhone audition saath mein hi le liya. Mere haath kaanp rahe the. Not because of Farah ma'am, but because I’d never played in front of her.
(a beat)

Lekin jaise hi pehla chords bajaye aur usne gaaya... pichle chaar saal jaise ki gaayab ho gaye. Like that never happened and everything felt right again.

He stares into the distance.

Luv

I don't know what I was afraid of? Maybe I felt guilty, aise laga ki mei kuch chupa raha hu, and everytime I heard anything about her, I always felt so proud and happy for her but at the same time, mujhe hamesha lagta tha ki main bas uske peeche daud raha hoon, just trying to catch up.
(a beat)
Uss din samajh aaya, uss music room mein ki she wasn’t running away, she never was, instead uska haath aage tha, mujhe saath kheenchne ke liye. And I didn't see it for a long time until it was almost too late.

TANISHA
Wow.. I knew ya'll have known each other for a long time but .. Itne saalo sei tu apnei andar hi rakh raha tha uskei liye yeh feelings?

LUV gets silent and doesn't look towards her; he continues on his path. They continue the rest of the journey silently.

ACT 3.

SCENE 1.

EXT. HILL TOP - LATE EVENING - Malabar hills End

LUV and TANISHA are walking up the road, on one side we see a man finishing his cigarette and is about to put it out when he turns and sees LUV and TANISHA walking towards them and at first there is shock on his face but he composes himself.

LUV looks at AMAN as he is walking towards them. At first there is a smile on his face but then he realises that TANISHA is next to him.

LUV
Oh AMAN(nonchalantly).. Oh AMAN(much more purpose).

AMAN ignores LUV.

AMAN
Ah TANISHA, itne time baad?! Yaha kya kar rahi hai?

TANISHA doesn’t answer. LUV makes a cutthroat gesture at AMAN who is too late to pick it up. AMAN looks at LUV asking what's wrong. There is an awkward silence for a long time.

TANISHA
Kyu AMAN? Kyu?

AMAN tries to act innocent and looks towards LUV for help who is as helpless as he is.

TANISHA
How could you do that AMAN. You swore. tuune bola ki we are meant to be forever aur phir? Phir tuune chod diya?

AMAN
Yeh phir vahi baat? Mei aur kya karta tha TANISHA! I really had no other choice!

TANISHA
Anything AMAN! Anything would have been fine! Par tumne… tumne toh kuch bhi nahi kiya!

AMAN
Wait tujhe kya lagta hai ki kya hua tha uss time?

TANISHA
Kya matlab mujhe kya lagta hai? Maine khudke aakhon se dekha tha AMAN

AMAN looks over at LUV who has not even tried to say a word.

LUV
Actually, let’s … you know let it out, bohot time se air out hogaya hai, TANISHA tu bolde isse

TANISHA looks at him confused.

TANISHA
The fuck bhai! Kya bolu? Sabko patta hai kya kiya hai isnei.

LUV looks at AMAN

AMAN
Par kya kiya maine? Mujhe yaad bhi nahi!

TANISHA
What do you mean by yaad bhi nahi?! Mei yaad dilaati hu. Mujhe bolta tha ki doston ke saat ghoom raha hu, par fir…

AMAN
Jitna mujhe teri galat fehmi door karni hai, time nahi hai mere paas, we’ll talk about it some other day, mei toh sirf isko lene aaya hu.

AMAN points towards LUV.

AMAN
LUV ghar chal.

LUV
I'm fine bro. Idhar thoda chill karke aauga, ya’ll go ahead. Catch up.

AMAN
Har mahine hum nahi kar sakte yeh LUV chal, ghar chal abhi.

AMAN steps forwards.

LUV
Thodi der keliye bas. I’ll join you later bhai, Pakka.

AMAN
LUV, tu har mahine yaha kyu aata hai?

LUV
Stop it.

AMAN
Kyu LUV? Har mahine, pandra ki shaam ko idhar kyu aata hai? Bol naa TANISHA ko.

LUV

Shut up.

TANISHA
What are you talking about?

AMAN
Tuune isse abhi tak bataya bhi nahi hoga!

TANISHA
About what? Tell me about what?

LUV looks down.

AMAN
If you don't say it, it doesn't mean that it didn't happen.

TANISHA
What is he talking about LUV?

LUV
Kuch nahi.

LUV glares at AMAN.

AMAN
Oh toh kuch nahi abhi?

LUV flares up and catches AMAN by the throat.

LUV
DON'T

AMAN
Don't kya LUV? Maar de mujhe, but you have to face reality at some point!

LUV lowers his arms down, sniffling.

LUV
Pata hai...pata hai mujhe, but nahi maalum how?!

LUV slides down and leans against the wall as he sits.

LUV

Almost do saal ho gaye hai. Mei university mei tha barely three months in. Har weekend milte thei we made it work somehow..

Aman

Get to the point KA-

TANISHA stops him.

LUV doesn’t pay attention and continues.

LUV

Uskei birthday keliye I had gone home. We celebrated it like we always did, balcony pei, with the cake and candles and everything…

(A beat)

She said she felt dizzy and couldn’t breathe, I can still see it all in slow motion. Mei sochta hu ki thoda aur quick hota toh…

(A beat)

I jumped over, I panicked, uncle walked in and immediately called the ambulance. It must have been barely ten minutes, par mujhe laga ki ghante beet gaye.

(A beat)

I sat in the emergency room, for god alone knows how long before the nurse said that she had regained consciousness.

(A beat)

Subhe tak baatei kiye. Dar laga ki, the next time it happens, I would be more aware.

(A beat)

She had to stay at the hospital for a few weeks, I bunked lectures till she convinced me ki sab theek hai.

(A beat)

Par uss weekend, blood tests aur bone marrow ke results came in. I mean you always hear about it, " Verma ji ke husband ko hogaya" oh, how sad and we move on. You don't feel the weight of it jabtak, aakho kei saamne naa ho toh.

By this time AMAN has been at a distance, with another cigarette in his hand but it's unlit, he just plays with it between his fingers. We can't see his face. TANISHA is nearer to LUV with a glossy look in her eyes. There are sounds of vehicles occasionally in the background. There's a long pause.

LUV

(Cont'd)

Cancer. Acute Leukemia. Din raat baithke research kiya, looked for saare treatment ke options.

(A beat)

We tried chemo, shifted her to the best hospital, state of the art facilities, and every well respected doctors in their field that we could find.

(A beat)

It seemed to be working, the colour in her face returned. She started smiling more and talking again. All I could do was wait, wait every week before I got to see her, har din video call kiya, phone ke baaju mei baithta tha waiting for it to ring.

(A beat)

Went home for my birthday, although I knew ki we wouldn't be able to celebrate it as usual, firbhi it felt alright as long as it was just the two of us. Mei kuch din jaldi aagaya, Delnaaz aunty ka cake kharidke hospital chala gaya. We talked, she asked how my music studies were going, I lied, Maine jhoot

bola ki it was fine. How could I tell her ki, all I could think about is how she was doing every waking moment of my day. She smiled.

(A beat)

We held hands as we listened to [insert song],she wished me ‘happy birthday’ and I fell asleep.

LUV takes deep breaths and struggles to say the next part. AMAN closer now TANISHA struggling to stand and understand what is being narrated to her.

LUV

(Cont’d)

Kuch ghante baad, jab mei utha I was on the sofa and I don’t know how I got there, she was lying there on the bed calm. I saw her hair over face and as soon as I touched it to move it, I knew something was wrong. I pressed the button to call the nurse and Time stopped for me, I was numb, I could see the doctors go around me in a blur, sawaal puuchte rahe aur mei jawaab dete gaya, bina samjhe ki kya bol raha hu.

(A beat)

It felt wrong, her parents were there, they just held me tight. I felt tears fall down my face and cry like I had never before. The weeks after that were a blur. I got kicked out of college for not attending, we cremated her, a lot of people showed up. I met Aman there.

(A beat)

Kuch din baad Aunty aayi ghar pei. She said that there was something Neha had left for me, but she wasn’t sure when I would be ready to receive it. At this point I was clinging on to everything that reminded me of her. Aunty ne ghar bulaya.

(A beat)

As I walked through that house like I had done a million times before, it felt empty and incomplete. We went to Neha’s room, there lying on the bed was a guitar and a note.

(A beat)

I picked up the note and read it. She said she was proud of me and how grateful she was for us to end up together even after all the ups and downs. She knew I wanted one for months, and I kept complaining about not having one.

(A beat)

I still look at her pictures everyday TANISHA, mei darta hu ki mei bhool jaaonga usko.

TANISHA wipes LUV’S face and holds him by his shoulders.

TANISHA

LUV look at me LUV. You won’t forget her, it’s not going to happen, par LUV tu aise..

TANISHA gestures around her.

TANISHA
(cont’d)

..aise nahi reh sakta LUV! I know that it’s hard but..

LUV
Tujhe kya maalum?! HOW DO YOU KNOW? YOU WEREN’T EVEN THERE!

TANISHA is shocked and is visibly about to burst into tears.

TANISHA
MERI BHI DOST THI VOH LUV! I DON’T DESERVE TO LEARN ABOUT IT LIKE THIS! TUJHE LAGTA HAI KI SIRF TUJHE HAQ HAI USSE PYAAR KARNE KAA?!

AMAN holds her back.

AMAN
He doesn’t mean it TANISHA! Voh gussei mei keh raha hai!

TANISHA
I don’t care! I care for her as much as he does!

AMAN
Calm down TANISHA

TANISHA
MEI KYU?

LUV has been bawling the whole time into his knees.

AMAN
Dimaag kharaab hai uska tera nahi!

TANISHA stops struggling and AMAN lets go of her, she walks away to the opposite side of the street. AMAN walks over to LUV.

AMAN
Dekh, tujhe joh bhi kuch bolni hai, mujhe bol, TANISHA ko aise cheeze mat bol. Thoda doosro ke baarei mei soch naa, poori duniya tere aaju baaju nahi ghoomti hai LUV.

LUV lifts his head up.

LUV
KYU ?! KYA MILTI HAI MUJHE DUNIYA SE? KYU SOCHU DOOSRO KE BAAREI MEI!? TUJHE TOH FIRBHI TANISHA MIL GAYI! MUJHE SIRF DARD MILTI HAI ZINDAGI SE AMAN!

AMAN
Tujhe lagta hai ki voh chahati hogi ki tu aise rahe? Tujhe lagta hai ki NEHA wouldn’t want you to move on? Tujhe lagta hai ki sirf tere liye unfair hai? Bhai theek hai, you loved her but hogaya hai do saal LUV move on kar! Tujhe lagta hai hum care nahi karte? voh humari bhi toh dost hai.

LUV
Move on? I am trying AMAN!

AMAN
Not hard enough!

LUV
Hamesha bas har cheezo mei voh dikthi hai, kuch accha dekhta hu to usko bolne kaa man karta hai par voh hai kidhar AMAN? Kidhar hai voh?

TANISHA composes herself and comes back towards LUV

LUV
Tumko kya? Tumlog ko firbhi mil jaayega closure, mera kya!

They stare at each other silently, all of them, even the stoic AMAN has tears down his cheeks and red eyes.

TANISHA
LUV sunn, aur is baar acche se, you moving on does not mean that you forget her. Lagta hoga but you have a life to live LUV?! Abhi we are there here now!

AMAN also gets closer and bends down.

AMAN
Tujhe pata hai, we cared about NEHA, and we care about you right?

LUV nods.

AMAN
(cont’d)
Did you forget about TANISHA itnei saalon mei LUV?

LUV nods no.

AMAN
Fir tu NEHA ko kaise bhulega? It is fine for you to accept it, agla step le LUV, holding on won’t help you in any way. Let go.

TANISHA
I know it’s hard, patta hai par hum hai idhar LUV! It’s fine let go.

LUV continues to sob as TANISHA hugs him and AMAN watches on . We fade to black.

## Act 4

### Scene 1 - Malabar Hills End

We see a hand scribbling something in a book , wide shot, we see it’s LUV. We see AMAN sitting on the ledge a bit away, TANISHA leans onto the lamp post but none of their faces. LUV completes writing, he puts his pen down. He picks up the guitar next to him and he starts to play. As we continue to listen to the song we end our shot on the city skyline as it slowly turns darker as credits appear while the music continues.

THE END